

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, less humid, high 83.
Tonight, clear, dry, light winds, low 69. Tomorrow, mostly sunny, warm, remaining dry, light winds, high 86.
Weather map appears on Page 28.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



FINBARR O'REILLY FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

An Ebola Victim’s Risky Burial
Men tamping down the earth in a grave in a Congolese village at the heart of the Ebola outbreak. Precautions were meager. Page 12.

White House Directs Patel to Lead Times Reporting Inquiry

This article is by **Devlin Barrett, Glenn Thrush and Maggie Haberman.**

WASHINGTON — The White House directed Kash Patel, the F.B.I. director, to oversee a leak investigation into reporting by The New York Times about security issues with the new Air Force One, leading to a flurry of subpoenas to several Times reporters Friday night, according to people with knowledge of the situation.

Mr. Patel scuttled a planned trip to Chicago and spent roughly eight hours at the White House on Friday, running the investigation from there rather than F.B.I. headquarters — a major departure from historical practice. Mr. Patel also briefed senior administration officials on the investigation, two people said. The people spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe sensitive internal discussions.

The White House’s deep involvement in the case came after

Air Force One Articles Prompt Subpoenas

officials said that President Trump was enraged about the coverage of the Qatari-donated plane, which The Times reported Thursday lacks the same defensive countermeasures of the previous Air Force One.

Mr. Trump flew on the new jet to

a NATO meeting in Turkey early last week, but was forced to change to the old plane when he departed because of Secret Service concerns, as The Times reported on Wednesday.

Mr. Patel’s role in the investigation, in close coordination with top administration officials, reflects a further dismantling of the wall that had separated the White House and the F.B.I. in previous administrations. The government’s effort to immediately seek

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JANE STOCKDALE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

In Ever Hotter London, Scrambling for a Swim
The competition for pools is fierce. So some are even wading into polluted ponds and canals. Page 8.

Hamptons Acquire a Taste for Chicken Nuggets

By DIONNE SEARCEY
MONTAUK, N.Y. — The sun was about to set across Fort Pond in Montauk, and the revelers gathered at the nearby Surf Lodge were just starting to indulge themselves. The music thumped. Champagne flowed. And, across the bar, sun-tanned hands reached into \$150 towers of Popeyes chicken tenders.

“You can’t take it with you,” said Stephen Gay, a real estate agent who sells luxury properties in Florida, who had splurged on a \$7,500 table that included the fast-food tenders and a flight of dip-

Nostalgia Served With a Dollop of Caviar

ping sauces. The Hamptons makes headlines for its luxury estates, helicopter commutes and extreme food options, including a \$129.99-a-pound lobster salad, \$400 Japanese melons and a set of vending machines that dispense tins of beluga caviar at \$225 for two ounces. But amid these hoity-toity status foods, the humble chicken tender — the fast-food icon, a kids-

menu staple — is thriving. By noon on any given day, the refrigerated cases in gourmet grocery stores — earlier stacked five high with containers of breaded, deep-fried chunks of chicken they call nuggets, fingers, strips or tenders — may well be picked clean. A few restaurants offer “adult chicken nuggets” on their menus. Some private chefs say homemade nuggets are their most requested item. And you should see how some of these tenders are living out east. They are often served with Hamptons flair — and, just as im-

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Japan Becomes Fertile Ground To Putin’s Spies

This article is by **Jane Bradley, Michael Schwartz and Adam Goldman.**

TOKYO — Soon after troops invaded Ukraine in February 2022, Western leaders expelled hundreds of Russian spies from their capitals and blacklisted companies with ties to the Kremlin.

The coordinated effort was intended to make it harder for the Kremlin to collect intelligence and buy equipment like microchips, transmitters and the machinery used to make weapons.

Since then, officials say, dozens of those banished spies have turned up in an unexpected place: Japan.

The country’s weak espionage laws and flourishing high-tech industry have made it a crucial piece of the Russian war effort. Ninety percent of Russian missiles and drones contain Japanese components, according to Ukrainian government estimates.

At the heart of the operation in Tokyo is a secretive military intelligence unit known as the 20th Directorate, whose role has never been publicly disclosed. Posing as diplomats or businesspeople, its officers work to buy or steal battlefield technology and smuggle it into Russia, according to current and former officials at five Western intelligence agencies.

The man overseeing the 20th Directorate’s operation in Tokyo maintains a cover identity as an employee of the Russian state airline Aeroflot, according to current officials from four of those intelligence agencies. He plays a crucial role in supplying Russia’s war machine.

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Rubio Controls Venezuela From Afar in Washington

Country’s Recovery Is Vital to Trump’s Goal of Securing American Access to Oil

By **TYLER PAGER and ANATOLY KURMANAEV**

WASHINGTON — President Trump was sitting in the Oval Office earlier this year with Secretary of State Marco Rubio when an idea came to him.

Maybe he should dispatch Mr. Rubio permanently to Caracas, the Venezuelan capital, where U.S. commandos had carried out the proudest foreign policy achievement of Mr. Trump’s second term: the capture of Nicolás Maduro, the country’s president.

Mr. Rubio could be the next leader of Venezuela, Mr. Trump suggested. And while the president’s aides say he was joking — and that he frequently teases Mr. Rubio about an overseas assignment — the fact is that Mr. Rubio does not need to move to Caracas.

He already runs Venezuela from Washington.

In the six months since U.S. forces blew open Mr. Maduro’s bedroom door and snatched him in the dead of night, Mr. Rubio has become the de facto viceroy of Venezuela, holding sway over a sovereign nation in a way that no American official has since L. Paul Bremer III arrived in Baghdad in 2003 to run U.S.-occupied Iraq.

Mr. Rubio now effectively controls Venezuela’s finances, the distribution of its natural resources and its government, according to interviews with more than a dozen officials and people close to both governments in Washington and Caracas, who provided details about his involvement in steering the country’s policies. Many

spoke on condition of anonymity to describe private interactions and internal discussions.

While he has not visited Venezuela in person since the U.S. took over, the secretary of state is deeply involved in the country’s day-to-day operations, keeping in close contact with Delcy Rodríguez, who was Mr. Maduro’s vice president and now leads her country on an acting basis, with the imprimatur of the United States. The two exchange messages in Spanish on WhatsApp, trading gossip, birthday greetings and selfies.

Despite the banter, the relationship between Mr. Rubio and Ms. Rodríguez is far from a partnership. It is a manifestation of Trump-era American power, in which the winner takes all regardless of sovereignty and international law.

The Venezuelan government did not respond to a request for comment. The Trump administration did not address detailed questions about Mr. Rubio’s authority in Venezuela. Mr. Rubio has downplayed his role, and largely avoids discussing his work. He declined multiple requests for an interview.

Tommy Pigott, a State Department spokesman, said in a statement that “with renewed cooperation and sound economic stewardship, Venezuela can re-emerge as a stable, prosperous partner whose citizens benefit from its

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WHISTLE-BLOWERS Documents accused the Kennedy Center of bypassing contracting norms in carrying out its renovations. PAGE 18

CRITIC OF SCIENTISTS Matthew M. Wielicki, who will oversee a key climate change report, has called himself a “professor in exile.” PAGE 18



MATTHEW STOCKMAN/GETTY IMAGES

Incandescent on Centre Court
Catherine, Princess of Wales, congratulated Wimbledon’s women’s champion, Linda Noskova of the Czech Republic. Page 22.

Collapse of Platner Candidacy Renews ‘Bernie Bros’ Criticism

By **PATRICIA MAZZEI and KELLEN BROWNING**

Last month, as accusations that Graham Platner of Maine had demeaned and threatened women consumed his Senate campaign, his left-wing allies closed ranks around him.

Representative Ro Khanna of California posted a video on social media sitting alongside Mr. Platner on a floating dock discussing “transformational politics.” Senator Bernie Sanders of Vermont said Mr. Platner had “gotten his life together” despite his troubling past.

“There are no saints in the United States Senate,” Mr. Sanders said at the time.

Last week, after one of those women accused Mr. Platner of

rape, those same politicians withdrew their support, and Mr. Platner, who denied the accusation, announced Wednesday that he was suspending his campaign. The collapse of his meteoric candidacy has turned what had been a triumph for progressives into a moment of political crisis.

It has also set off a broader debate among Democrats around the country about the movement that Mr. Sanders leads: Is its embrace of a blunt and brawny populism too dismissive of women — and too forgiving of male misconduct? The question is not new, but it has grown more urgent this year, when the party has elevated

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A New Data Center Divide
Big Tech is targeting tribal land for development, which has pitted the need for economic opportunity against a history of outside exploitation. PAGE 14

Warning of Peril of Lab Leak
The U.S. government has underestimated the danger should plutonium escape Los Alamos, a study said. PAGE 15

METROPOLITAN

Life After an Acid Attack
Nafiah Ikram has been working to regain her health and to cope with a twist in a criminal inquiry. PAGE 8



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Left Behind by China’s Robots
Jobless factory workers in Kunshan, a rich electronics manufacturing hub, find solace in a park. PAGE 13

U.S. Resumes Iran Strikes
Tehran attacked a container ship and then announced that the Strait of Hormuz was closed again. PAGE A9

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If You Want to Live Abroad
As some countries curtail residency-by-investment programs, there are still attractive “golden visa” plans for Americans. PAGE 6

ARTS & LEISURE

Broadening Musical Horizons
The conductor Joe Hisaishi got famous by composing film soundtracks. Now he is concentrating on his first love: classical music. PAGE 5

SUNDAY OPINION

Jonathan Mingle PAGE 6



SUNDAY STYLES

A Story of Too Many Books
Mendel Uminier faced a crisis when his landlord objected to the 10,000 volumes in his New York apartment. PAGE 1

SUNDAY BUSINESS

Helping A.I. Destroy Work
Start-ups are paying white-collar professionals to teach their jobs to artificial intelligence models. Why would people participate in feeding their own careers into the wood chipper? PAGE 6

Terrorized by a Tech Company
The documentary “Whatever It Takes: Inside the eBay Scandal” examines a plot to cyberstalk critics as well as the victims’ fight for justice. PAGE 1

